

CHAPTER 2: ANYBODY CAN DO THIS: TRUE STORIES

BECAUSE IT SOUNDS UTTERLY MAGICAL TO INVEST \$10,000 in a stock and walk away with \$1 million some years later, Phelps emphasized how investing in 100-baggers was something achievable by anyone. One way he did this was to tell stories of real people who managed the feat.

I have many examples of my own.

When I started the 100-bagger project and began writing about it, I got a lot of email from readers who had netted a 100-bagger. People told me their stories. It is worth sharing a sampling of these early on because they help set the tone. Ordinary people can do this. You don't have to have an MBA or work at a hedge fund. And as you'll see, the lessons people drew from their experiences are exactly the ones this book will reinforce.

Here's one email:

As an active investor and trader for 30 years I have come to the realization that this 100-bagger approach and philosophy is the way one should approach a lifetime of investing. If one could only receive the proper level of mentoring as a young man, to commit oneself to this course. ... If only I knew this when I started out, I would not only be wealthier, but my quality of life would have been vastly better through all those years.

I have had my share of home runs and plenty of disasters. I have spent countless days glued to the computer screen monitoring positions and trades. Over a career of investing and speculating the only real money that I held onto were [sic] in longer-term